found the aspect of the prisoners quite changed; nor could I wonder to hear that a quarter of the house is soon to be fitted up for an infirmary.

BRUGES. The hospital in this city is a very spacious and airy room, with a wainscot partition or screen which divides the men from the women. The great attention of the nuns distinguishes the hospitals in Roman Catholic countries. Their recluse life gives them a pale look, and is the reason, probably, why the wards of the patients are kept too close; here however they look very healthy. There are twenty of them, who rise at four, and are constantly employed about their numerous patients. The directress of the pharmacy last year celebrated her jubilee or fiftieth year of residence.

These sisters asked, whether I was a Catholic? I answered: "I love good people of all religions." Then, said they, "We hope you will die a Catholic."

PORTUGAL

Imprisonment for debt is prohibited in Portugal by an ordinance made in 1774. There is an entire separation of the sexes in prisons and infirmaries. No garnish is taken in prisons; but I found the bad custom prevalent here of detaining prisoners for the gaoler's fees: those fees are often paid by a charitable society called the Misericordia. Many from the first families in the kingdom are of this order. They send provisions twice a week to several prisons; and, like the Confraternità della Misericordia at Rome, pay great attention to capital convicts. Criminals here are often kept in confinement for several years before they are brought to trial; and sometimes, even after being tried and condemned, they lie in prison some years before they are executed.[1] I saw some convicts at Lisbon going from prison to embark for the settlements in the Brazils. Such convicts as are designed for India are enrolled as soldiers, and sent to a house (or hospital) on the other side of the river, where they are kept some weeks, to bathe, and to be better clothed and fed, that they may be properly prepared for their long voyage.

[1] Before the Marquis of Pombal's administration, gaolers used often to let their prisoners out on their *parole*. One thus favoured, was ordered for execution seven years after he had been condemned. On the gaoler's summons, he immediately returned to the prison from his work in the country. For this punctual regard to his promise he received a pardon.

LISBON. The great prison at Lisbon, Limoiero (formerly a palace) is designed for the reception of prisoners from the provinces as well as from the city. There were seven hundred and seventy-four, on 21 February, 1783. In one of the lower wards there were seventy criminals, but none in irons. On the first floor there were many who paid for better accommodation, and received no donations from the Misericordia. Here civil and criminal causes are tried in a large hall called Caza da Supplicaçam, which the prisoners use for a day-room and lodging-room: the courts of justice are opened at eight or nine in the morning. There are two infirmaries, one for each sex; in that for men there were eighteen persons, in single beds with proper bedding: their room looked towards the river, and was spacious, clean, and airy. In the room for the condemned, the beds were in recesses. Over these, in a large gallery latticed, there were beds for the sick from the secret or private chambers. In this country, and also in Spain, one seldom sees glass windows; but in prisons, never.

The ecclesiastical prison (Aljube), near the great church, is under the jurisdiction of the Patriarch. It consists of four rooms and a small chapel. Here were confined six priests, and three women. In this and the other prisons, the prisoners may be conversed with through the iron grates: but I always went into the prisons.

In a prison by the rope-walk near the river, many of the nobles and priests were confined in the time of the Marquis of Pombal's administration. Here, nineteen vaulted rooms open into a passage: I measured some of them, they were about twenty feet by nine. The wall was six feet two inches thick. In the entrance to each room there were three doors; the middle one was an iron grate with round bars. Over each of the doors there was an aperture to admit light, except in two rooms called secret, which were totally dark.

BELLEM. The prison at Bellem (about two miles from Lisbon) has four rooms below, and several on the first floor for those who pay. Criminals less atrocious than those sent to Limoiero are here confined. The prisoners subsist by charitable donations; and the gaoler told me, that he had a right to a fee from every one discharged.

LISBON. In the arsenal are four large rooms for the slaves or convicts, most of whom are Moors. Some work at the rope-walk, others fetch water, a few are closely confined, and three or four chained to one spot; one of whom (an Italian)